

BARCLAYS INTERN EXPERIENCE

About the Company – Barclays :

Barclays is a global bank offering banking, credit cards, wealth, and other forms of financial provision. It is one of the companies majorly focusing on innovation and technology. The company utilizes young talents and provides them with an opportunity to work on scalable applications, microservices, and functional solutions in an interactive environment.

Role - Technology Summer Intern :

In the role of Barclays internship, application and microservices should be designed and developed in a scalable manner. Server components and the functional solution should be created and implemented. Its main tasks include collaborating with product owners and the end-users to elicit requirements and do unit testing and planning the release of the software. The role also includes code reviews as well as support given for business-as-usual (BAU) activities related to the applications.

Duration: 8 weeks

Overview of the process:

The selection process began with an online coding round that tested different skill sets in three sections:

1. **Section 1:** 12 multiple-choice questions (MCQs) covering object-oriented programming (OOP) concepts, code output predictions, and error detection.
2. **Section 2:** One medium-level Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA) question related to strings.
3. **Section 3:** One SQL query-based question involving a table structure.

How I Cleared the First Round :

I prepared for this round by working extensively with the Standard Template Library (STL) and solving problems on platforms like LeetCode. Although I wasn't deeply into competitive programming (CP), I gradually learned to solve problems more efficiently. By focusing on simpler techniques and using STL containers effectively, I was able to enhance my problem-solving approach.

This not only improved my understanding of algorithms but also helped me utilize these techniques for solving complex problems.

I particularly enjoyed solving SQL queries, which allowed me to apply new techniques and gain practical insights. With a better grasp of efficient problem-solving strategies, I cleared the online round, where 29 students were shortlisted for the interview.

Interview Process :

I was asked to bring three resumes, and I made sure to have a clear format that presented my skills and experience well. The interview process had both technical and HR components, conducted by two senior employees – one of them the head of the interview process, and the other a database (DB) head.

- **Introduction:** I started the interview by introducing myself without being prompted, mentioning that I'm a 3rd-year student at CEG and expressing my interest in full-stack projects and DSA. I also highlighted my soft skills, such as being organized, adaptable, and having leadership qualities, which helped me make a strong first impression.
- **Technical Questions:**
 - The technical discussion began with database-related questions. I was asked to explain how databases work, the requirements for designing a database, and to provide a real-time example of how a distributed database management system (DDBMS) works, using Amazon as a case study.
 - I was also asked to explain my machine learning (ML) project and how databases integrated with it.
 - I was asked to write pseudocode and SQL queries related to joins, subqueries, and functions.
- **Situational and Behavioral Questions:**
 - I was presented with a situation where my colleague disagreed with my idea and suggested a new one. I had to explain how I would handle the situation.
 - I was asked why I chose Barclays, to which I responded confidently based on the research I had done about the company's work culture and values.

I also discussed my hobbies, which include reading Tamil books, writing Tamil poems, and doing pencil sketches. They asked me to recite one of my poems and explain its meaning, as well as describe my favorite artwork.

Tips for Future Applicants :

1. **Research the Company:** Make sure to thoroughly research the company's background, work culture, and values. This will help you confidently answer HR questions like "Why Barclays?" and give you an edge in making a positive impression.
2. **Technical Preparation:** Focus on both DBMS and DSA topics, as many technical questions in interviews may revolve around these areas. Revise key concepts and practice regularly on platforms like **LeetCode** to gain exposure to a wide variety of problems. Solving problems in a **step-by-step manner** using simpler techniques can help in tackling more complex challenges later. Make use of **STL (in C++)** for efficient coding, especially if you're into competitive programming (CP). Additionally, regularly **solve SQL queries** to enhance your database knowledge.
3. **Mock Interviews:** Practice mock interviews focusing on both technical and HR questions. Be prepared for situational questions to showcase your problem-solving and interpersonal skills.
4. **Resume Preparation:** Ensure your resume is clear, concise, and formatted well. It should effectively present your strengths and make it easy for interviewers to grasp your experience.

Wishing you the best—approach the process with confidence and have hope. Hope is the only thing I have throughout my process. May that helps you feel good ra. Here luck and blessings play a few role I feel so :)

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